iii. The Lower course

The river, moving downstream across a broad, level plain is loaded with debris, brought down from its upper and middle courses. Large deposits of sediments are found at the level bed and the river, splits into a number of channels called distributaries. The main work of the river here is **deposition** and it develops typical landforms like **delta and estuary.**

- **Tributary** – Small streams that join the main river. Eg. River Bhavani
- **Distributary** – River channels that get separated from the main river. E.g., River Kollidam.

Erosional Landforms of River

Gorges and Canyons:

When the river flows through a mountainous region made up of hard rocks, it forms a valley with almost vertical sides called gorge. In India, deep gorges have been formed by Brahmaputra and Indus in the Himalayas.

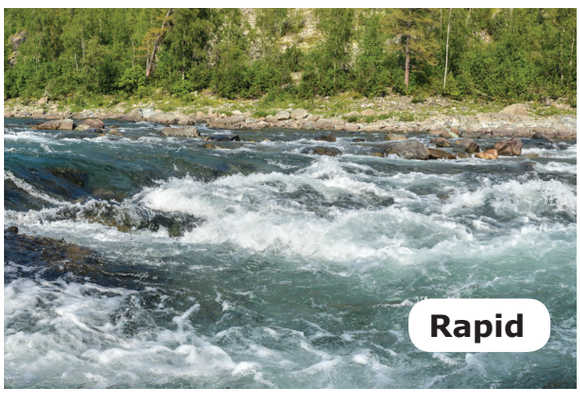
A deep gorge with steep sides that runs for hundreds of kilometres is referred to as canyon e.g. Grand Canyon of the river Colorado in the U.S.A.



Waterfall

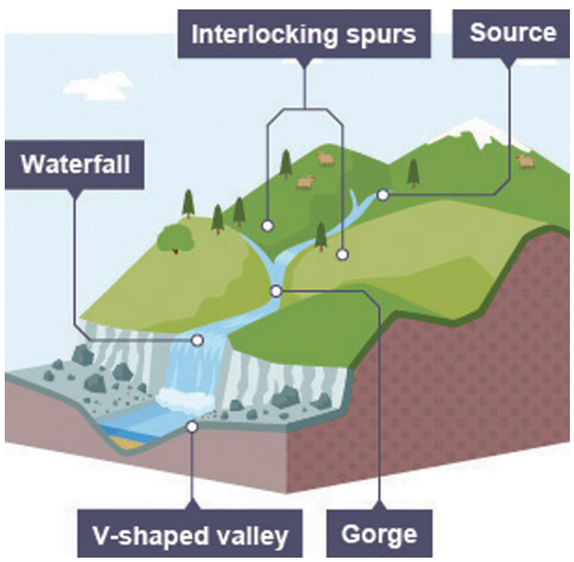
When a river flows in a region where hard rocks lie over soft rocks horizontally, the soft rocks get eroded quickly and the hard rocks projects outwards. Thus, the river falls vertically from a steep slope to form a **waterfall**. When the water falls with great force, it erodes the rock material beneath and creates a depression called a **plunge pool**. Shallow fast flowing water in a stream is called a **rapid** or **river jumps**

The highest waterfalls in the world is Angel falls (979 m) in Venezuela.



V-shaped valley

A 'V'- shaped valley is formed by the vertical erosion of the river where the valley is deepened and widened.



Pot hole

Due to the river action, cylindrical holes are drilled vertically in the river bed, with varying depth and diametre. These are called **pot holes**.

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